

Week 1 · Task 1 – Cyber Security Intro + What is a SOC?

1. The CIA Triad

The foundational framework for information security strategy across enterprise systems:



- **Confidentiality:** Prevents unauthorized access to sensitive data using encryption, MFA, and access controls.
- **Integrity:** Guarantees data accuracy and prevents unauthorized modifications via hashing and digital signatures.
- **Availability:** Ensures continuous access to applications and systems through redundancy and DDoS protection.

2. What is a Security Operations Center (SOC)?

A Security Operations Center (SOC) is a centralized command unit within an organization that continuously monitors, detects, analyzes, and responds to cybersecurity incidents. Powered by SIEM tools, EDR solutions, and threat intelligence, the SOC acts as the defensive shield protecting digital infrastructure 24/7/365.

3. SOC Analyst Tiers & Hierarchy

SOC operations are structured into specialized tiers to manage incident triage and escalation efficiently:

Tier Level	Primary Role & Focus	Key Responsibilities
Tier 1: Triage Analyst	Initial Alert Monitoring & Filter	Monitors SIEM dashboards, filters false positives, performs basic triage, and escalates true threats.
Tier 2: Incident Responder	In-Depth Investigation & Containment	Investigates escalated alerts, analyzes host/network logs, isolates infected endpoints, and remediates threats.
Tier 3: Threat Hunter / Lead	Advanced Hunting & Forensics	Proactively hunts undetected threats, performs malware analysis and deep forensics, and refines SOC detection rules.

4. Red Team vs. Blue Team

Enterprise cybersecurity relies on a collaborative dynamic between offensive and defensive teams:

RED TEAM (Offensive)

- Simulates Real-World Attacks
- Finds System Blindspots
- Penetration Testing & Exploitation

BLUE TEAM (Defensive)

- Defends Infrastructure
- 24/7 Monitoring & Incident Response
- Hardens Security Controls

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